



Under-display camera

Take a look at the official video with Xiaomi's under-display front-facing camera. <http://dgit.in/sep20-15>



Intel Tiger Lake leak

Leakster WalkingCat leaked a 50-second Intel Tiger Lake processors promotional video. <http://dgit.in/sep20-16>

ASUS ROG ZEPHYRUS G14

Small, powerful and packing heat

There's undoubtedly been an incredible amount of anticipation surrounding the Asus ROG Zephyrus G14. The laptop is definitely the first of its kind, in terms of the combination of power and form-factor, so there were definitely a lot of expectations. So, let's see if it manages to meet those lofty expectations.

Build and Design

The Asus ROG Zephyrus G14 is being launched in an array of configurations, which include the AMD Ryzen 5 4600H, Ryzen 7 4800HS and Ryzen 9 4900HS processors. Based on the processor, you can choose from Nvidia GPUs, going as high as the Nvidia GeForce RTX 2060 Max-Q. Display options range between a 1080p 120Hz panel and a 2K 60Hz display, both of which utilise IPS technology and are Pantone validated.

The Asus ROG Zephyrus G14 comes equipped with the Intel 660p NVMe drive, based on QLC cache. Unfortunately, and understandably, there's no secondary m.2 slot on this tiny machine. In terms of read/write speeds, users can expect 1740MB/s read and 1690MB/s write.

The keys on the G14's keyboard are interesting. They are rounded around the edges and offer 1.4mm of travel. The actuation point of the keys is consistent and the feedback is pretty substantial. The keyboard, however, does miss out on some critical, standard keys. There's no Page Up or Page Down keys, not even as a combo. While the trackpad on the smaller side, the surface is made of glass and your fingers will glide over it, with the cursor responding to every touch and every gesture. The port selection



BUILD AND DESIGN.....72
PERFORMANCE.....72
VALUE.....70
FEATURE.....65

is something we were pretty happy about. There are two full-sized USB 3.0 ports on the right side that operate at 5Gbps, accompanied by a USB-C port operating at 10Gbps speeds. The left side houses the power connector and a full-sized HDMI port and another USB-C port with DisplayPort 1.4 and 65W power delivery capabilities.

Performance

The panel supports a maximum of 60Hz refresh rate. We tested 14 games in both 1440p and 1080p resolutions. We hoped for a minimum of 60fps across the board, irrespective of the game. Thankfully, disappointment was not on the cards. Whatever game you throw at the ROG Zephyrus G14, it will run it at impressive frame rates.

One of the best things about the Zephyrus G14 is that despite being a gaming laptop, its hardware is suited for creators as well. The AMD Ryzen 9 4900HS packs 8 cores and 16 threads paired with an Nvidia GeForce RTX 2060 Max-Q. This combination makes it a great tool for using Adobe Lightroom Classic, Premiere Pro, DaVinci Resolve or any creative application.

If the Asus Zephyrus G14 has a weak spot, it's thermals. The Ryzen 9 4900HS can run at up to 105 degree Celsius and there's no harm if it gets

into the high 90s, which it often does. During all our gaming and rendering runs, the CPU would occasionally go all the way up to 98-degrees. The problem, however, stems from the fact that the surface temperatures across the keyboard and the under-side were uncomfortably hot.

Now coming to the display, it clocked a peak brightness of 300 lux. The display is Pantone calibrated at the factory. The matte coating does a good job of keeping reflections at bay.

Our repeated tests using PCMark 10's built-in Office battery benchmark returned us less than stellar results. Our battery life numbers hovered in the 4 hours 30 minute to 3 hour range, even with the laptop set to Windows profile in Armory crate, and Windows choosing the best battery life settings.

Bottom Line

The Asus ROG Zephyrus G14 is a one-of-a-kind laptop and also the first of its kind. This is the first time we're seeing such powerful gaming hardware packed into such a tiny 14-inch chassis. It still does not defy physics, and as such, does have trouble dissipating heat due to the limited surface area. We don't note any throttling of the Ryzen 9 4900HS, but do note unacceptably high temperatures on the surface of the keyboard. The Anime Matrix display on the G14 is also quite an eye-catcher and a gimmick, but unlike most others, this gimmick has been implemented well. Overall, for the money, you could buy laptops that deliver better performance, but with the Zephyrus G14, you're paying for a good amount of power packed into a compact form-factor.

—Swapnil Mathur

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: AMD Ryzen 9 4900HS | RAM: 16GB DDR4 | STORAGE: 1TB NVMe (Intel 660p) | GPU: Nvidia GeForce RTX 2060 Max-Q | DISPLAY: 2560x1440, 60Hz | ANIME MATRIX LID: Yes

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